which had been the location of the bloody clash of 15 June, was to become a buffer zone with no movement by either side. This was agreeable to both sides, and after ratification by the authorities on their side, the PLA conveyed their acceptance of this proposal through a Hot Line message.

Based on this, the timeline for the disengagement was worked out and over two days, the PLA fell back, removing all their tents and shelters and restoring all land forms to as near their original state as possible.[9] By the 6th morning, the PLA had vacated this entire area, and it was a good start to the disengagement process. During these talks, disengagement from PP-15 and PP-17A had also been discussed, but since we were making headway on PP-14, we did not press too much on these locations. Nevertheless, the PLA did make some token reductions at both locations by pulling back their most forward elements. However, the more important issue of the North Bank of the Pangong Tso remained unresolved, with the PLA once again insisting that we should resolve these issues first (PP-14, PP-15 and PP-17A) while remaining non-committal on the North Bank.

In the fourth round held on 14 July, the focus now shifted towards disengagement on the North Bank of the Pangong Tso, i.e., a step-wise withdrawal of personnel, weapons and equipment to mutually agreed distances; as well as de-escalation, to reduce the overall forces of both sides in the region.[10] Additionally, legacy issues of Depsang and Demchok were also raised, which pre-dated the stand-offs of May 2020.[11] Once again, the PLA responded with the same old formulation of 'let us settle current issues first and then we will consider discussing the others'. As far as the North Bank was concerned, the PLA had made considerable changes to the land form and had put up a large number of shelters for habitat and administrative

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